

Interactive - Algorithmic Performance Score

Title: Drifting Topologies

Tool: Free sound Explorer

Student (Performer): Christian Kenechukwu Anene

1. Overview of the Piece:

Drifting Topologies is an interactive, rule-based ambient performance that explores slow movement, texture-based decision making, and spatial navigation through the Free sound Explorer map.

The performer interacts with clusters of ambient sounds, following a set of algorithmic rules that determine movement, timing, and sound selection.

*The piece lasts approximately **3 minutes**,*

2. Setup Instructions

- Open Free sound Explorer in a window browser.
- In the search bar, type: ambient or any other genre of your choice.
- Allow the Sound Explorer map to load fully.
- Ensure audio is audible and screen recording is active.

3. Starting Conditions

Zoom out until the entire sound map is visible.

- A. Roll a die or pick a Start region of your choice.
 - *Start in the top-left region*
 - *Start in the top-right region*
 - *Start in the bottom-left region*
 - *Start in the bottom-right region*
- B. Move your cursor to the chosen region.
- C. Zoom in until individual dots are clearly visible.
- D. Click one dot to begin your performance.

4. Performance Rules

Rule 1 - *Duration Response*

After clicking a dot.

- If the sound is short (**3 seconds**) click two nearby dots in the same cluster.
- If the sound is long (**3 seconds**) wait 5 seconds before taking any action.

Rule 2 - *Texture Response*

Listen to the quality of the sound.

- If the sound is soft, airy, or ambient – (***stay in the same cluster and click one adjacent dot***).
- If the sound is tonal or droning – (***move diagonally across the map and click a dot in the new area or same area.***)
- If the sound is noisy, harsh, or percussive zoom out,
- Move to a visually different region and zoom in,
- Click a new dot and continue.

Rule 3 - *Time-Based Movement*

Every 20 seconds (you count internally or stopwatch)

- Zoom out
- Move to a new region of the map
- Zoom in
- Click a dot to continue

Rule 4 - *Density Response*

If you hear three or more sounds overlapping.

- Stop clicking for 10 seconds
- After the pause, move slightly to a less dense area and continue

5. Ending Rule

When you encounter a long, calm, stable sound.

- Click it
- Allow it to play without further interaction
- End the performance after it naturally fades or after 10 seconds.

Stop the screen recording.

6. Notes for the Performer

- Move slowly and intentionally.
- Allow space between actions - the piece should feel drifting, gentle, and atmospheric.
- Follow the rules strictly, even if they lead to unexpected transitions.
- The performance should feel like navigating a landscape rather than playing an instrument.

7. Duration

Approx. this piece lasted **3 minutes**, depending on how your own rules unfold.